

David Morrison

Community & Ecosystem Leader · Strategic Communications

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PROFILE

Community, ecosystem, and communications leader with 7+ years in crypto and fintech. Progressed from Community Lead to Head of Creative Campaigns & Social Media at NEAR Foundation, where I led social growth, community surfaces, ecosystem campaigns, global event presence, and technical narrative work. I now lead social for technical Layer 1 and onchain trading products at Douro Labs, working directly with founders, engineers, and product teams. Crypto-native since 2014 and a hands-on builder of AI-enabled consumer products.

RELEVANT EXPERTISE

Community & ecosystem strategy · Integrated communications · Foundation narrative · Crypto-native social/X · Technical translation · Developer and founder audiences · Partnerships and co-marketing · Global events · Team leadership and mentoring · Agencies and stakeholders · AI products · Audience measurement

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Douro Labs

May 2025 – Present

Social Lead, Special Projects

- Lead social strategy and daily communications for special projects across Layer 1 infrastructure and onchain perpetuals.
- Set the public voice for products built around market structure, matching systems, and fast execution.
- Translate sub-40ms block times, colocation consensus, and trading infrastructure into accurate messaging for developers, traders, and broader crypto audiences.
- Work directly with founders, engineers, product, growth, and sales to shape positioning before launch and keep the public narrative accurate after launch.

NEAR Foundation

Jul 2021 – May 2025

Head of Creative Campaigns & Social Media

Progression: Community Lead → Community Engagement Lead → Head of Social Media → Head of Creative Campaigns & Social Media

- Led social, community, creative campaign, and audience strategy for a global open-source blockchain ecosystem.
- Delivered a **500% increase in X followers in six months**.
- Delivered a **600% increase in share of voice in under three months** by targeting developer and ecosystem audiences directly.
- Ran the ecosystem's largest CoinGecko co-marketing campaign, bringing in **20,000 users and 10,000+ on-chain transactions**.
- Set the strategy for NEAR's forum and Discord; both reached all-time activity highs during my tenure.
- Worked with leadership and co-founder Illia Polosukhin on positioning, brand strategy, campaign direction, and public communications.
- Hired and mentored a Marketing Executive from onboarding through to independent ownership.
- Represented NEAR at international conferences and ecosystem events, presented on stage, and interviewed industry leaders.

Plutus.it

Jul 2018 – Sep 2021

Community Manager & Customer Service Team Lead

- Owned community and audience-facing channels across Discord, Telegram, BitcoinTalk, and Reddit for a crypto fintech product.
- Created an ambassador programme for highly active community members.
- Built the customer-support operation from scratch, including Zendesk, live chat, guides, and an FAQ database.
- Worked with marketing to drive audience growth and wrote due-diligence reports on potential partners for the executive team.

Earlier: Sales, Dixons Carphone (2015–2018); Crew Trainer, McDonald's (2011–2015).

ADDITIONAL FIT

- Partners and stakeholders:** led co-marketing work and collaborated with agencies, senior leaders, and ecosystem partners across time zones.
- AI fluency:** builds and operates AI-enabled products including MascotVibe and Infinite Strip; worked directly with transformer co-author Illia Polosukhin at NEAR.
- International presence:** public speaker and ecosystem representative at conferences and activations around the world.

EDUCATION & LINKS

Northumbria University · BSc Computer & Digital Forensics, 2015–2018

Dissertation: A Forensic Investigation into Bitcoin and TOR

General Assembly · Product Management, 2021

davidmorrison.me · linkedin.com/in/davidmorrison12 · Conference presentation · Industry interview